

Absolutely — **carve** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...which has helped them **carve out a niche** in the local area.”

Here **carve out** is figurative. It means **to gradually create or establish a distinct position for yourself through effort**, especially in a market, career, or field. But **carve** also has major literal meanings involving **cutting wood/stone, cutting food, shaping material, and figuratively creating a path/role/identity**.

Word family: **carve / carving / carved / carver**

Base word: carve

Verb forms: carve, carves, carved, carving

Related nouns: carving, carver

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun-family forms

Meaning in your passage: **carve out a niche = 建立自己的市場定位 / 特色位置**

Your sentence:

> “...they also make custom birthday cakes, which has helped them **carve out a niche** in the local area.”

Here **carve out a niche** means:

> **to gradually establish a distinctive position or specialized market for yourself through effort and differentiation.**

繁體中文：

靠自己的特色、努力或專門服務，在市場 / 社群中建立一個明確而獨特的位置；開拓自己的市場定位 / 立足點

Natural translation:

> “...helped them carve out a niche in the local area.”

「.....幫助他們在區內**建立自己的特色市場定位 / 開拓出自己的立足點**。」

So here:

> **carve out a niche = 在市場中逐步建立獨特定位**

1. **carve = cut wood/stone into a shape — 雕刻；雕成**

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “He **carved** a bird from wood.”

「他用木頭**雕刻**出一隻鳥。」

Practice 2

> “The statue was carved from stone.”

「這座雕像用石頭**雕成的**。」

****carve = 用刀具等切削木頭、石頭等材料，使其形成特定形狀或圖案****

2. **carve = cut a design/name into a surface — 刻；刻上**

A very common literal sense.

Practice 3

> “Someone had **carved** a name into the table.”

「有人在桌面上**刻了一個名字**。」

Practice 4

> “The date was carved into the stone.”

「日期被**刻在石頭上**。」

****carve = 在表面切出文字、圖案或記號****

3. **carve = cut cooked meat into pieces — 切肉；切片分肉**

A major food sense.

Practice 5

> “He **carved** the roast chicken.”

「他把烤雞**切開分件**。」

Practice 6

> “She carved the turkey at the table.”

「她在餐桌旁把火雞**切片分食**。」

carve — food = 把整塊熟肉 / 家禽切成可食用的片或份量

This is a genuinely distinct everyday sense.

4. **carving = carved object/artwork — 雕刻品 ; 雕刻作品**

A major noun form.

Practice 7

> “The museum displayed a wooden **carving**.”

「博物館展示了一件木製**雕刻品**。」

Practice 8

> “The carving showed a traditional pattern.”

「這件**雕刻作品**呈現傳統圖案。」

carving = 經雕刻製成的物件 / 藝術作品

5. **carving = act/art of carving — 雕刻 ; 雕刻技藝**

Practice 9

> “Wood **carving** requires patience.”

「木雕**雕刻技藝**需要耐性。」

Practice 10

> “She learned stone carving.”

「她學習**石雕**。」

carving = 雕刻這個活動、工藝或技術

6. **carver = person who carves — 雕刻師；雕刻者**

Practice 11

> “The **carver** worked carefully on the wood.”

「那位**雕刻師**仔細處理木材。」

Practice 12

> “He trained as a stone carver.”

「他接受訓練成為一名**石雕師**。」

carver = 以雕刻為工作 / 技能的人

7. **carve out = create a space/path by cutting — 切開形成；挖出**

Literal phrasal use.

Practice 13

> “The river **carved out** a deep valley.”

「河流**侵蝕形成 / 沖刷出**一個深谷。」

Practice 14

> “Workers carved out a passage through the rock.”

「工人在岩石中**鑿出**一條通道。」

carve out = 透過切削、侵蝕或挖掘形成空間 / 形狀

This is the literal base of the figurative source use.

8. **carve out = establish/create something through effort — 開創；建立**

A major figurative sense.

Practice 15

> “She **carved out** a successful career in design.”

「她在設計界**開創出一番成功事業**。」

Practice 16

> “The company carved out a strong position in the market.”

「公司在市場上**建立了穩固位置**。」

carve out = 經過努力，在競爭環境中逐步建立某個位置、角色、事業或領域

9. **carve out a niche = 開拓利基；建立獨特定位**

This is your exact source pattern.

Practice 17 — Original

> “The bakery has **carved out a niche** in the local area.”

「這間麵包店在本地**建立了自己的獨特市場定位**。」

Practice 18

> “The brand carved out a niche by focusing on handmade products.”

「這個品牌靠專注手工產品，成功**開拓了自己的利基市場**。」

carve out a niche = 靠差異化 / 專門化，在市場或領域中建立一個獨特位置

10. **carve out time = 擠出時間；騰出時間**

A common figurative extension.

Practice 19

> “She **carved out time** to visit the bakery.”

「她**擠出時間**去那間麵包店。」

Practice 20

> “You need to carve out time for rest.”

「你需要**騰出時間**休息。」

carve out time = 從繁忙安排中刻意騰出一段時間

This is a phrasal construction, but highly common and semantically useful.

11. **carve out a role / identity** = 建立角色 / 塑造身份

Practice 21

> “He carved out a new role for himself.”

「他為自己**建立了一個新的角色定位**。」

Practice 22

> “The brand carved out a distinct identity.”

「這個品牌**塑造出鮮明的品牌身份**。」

carve out = 在既有環境中逐步形成自己的角色、身份或定位

12. **carve a path / route** = 開闢道路；闖出路

A figurative/literal bridge sense.

Practice 23

> “The company carved a path into a new market.”

「公司在新市場中**闖出一條路**。」

Practice 24

> “She carved her own path instead of following others.”

「她沒有跟隨別人，而是**走出自己的路**。」

carve a path = 透過努力建立前進路線；比喻開創自己的方向

13. **carved = decorated/shaped by carving — 雕刻的；有刻紋的**

Practice 25

> “The bakery had a **carved** wooden sign.”

「麵包店有一塊**雕刻木牌**。」

Practice 26

> “The door had beautifully carved patterns.”

「門上有精美的**雕刻圖案**。」

carved = 經雕刻加工或帶有刻紋的

Important distinction: **carve vs cut**

cut

very broad:

= 切、割、剪

carve

more specific:

= 有目的地切削材料形成形狀、圖案；或把熟肉切片

> cut wood

> = 切木頭

> carve wood

> = 雕刻木頭

> cut chicken

> = 切雞肉

> carve a roast chicken

> = 把整隻烤雞切片 / 分件

Important distinction: **carve vs sculpt**

carve

= remove material by cutting/chipping.

sculpt

= create sculpture by carving, modelling, casting, etc.

So:

> carve stone

> = 雕刻石頭

> sculpt a figure

> = 雕塑一個人物

Carving is one possible sculpting technique.

Important distinction: **carve vs engrave**

You already mapped **engrave**.

carve

= cut more deeply / shape material.

engrave

= cut/incise words or designs into a surface, usually more precise/fine.

> carve a statue

> = 雕刻雕像

> engrave a name on a ring

> = 在戒指上刻名字

There is overlap, but **engrave** is more surface-inscription focused.

Important distinction: **carve vs slice**

slice

= cut into thin flat pieces.

carve

= cut cooked meat into serving portions.

> slice bread

> = 把麵包切片

> carve turkey

> = 把火雞切片分食

Important distinction: **carve out vs build**

build

= construct/grow something directly.

carve out

= create a place/position through effort, often despite competition or constraints.

> build a career

> = 建立事業

> carve out a career

> = 靠自己闖出 / 開創事業

Carve out adds the image of forcing out a space for yourself.

Important distinction: **carve out a niche vs find a niche**

find a niche

= discover a suitable specialized market/role.

carve out a niche

= actively create/establish that niche through effort.

So:

> find = 找到

> carve out = 開拓 / 建立

Your bakery passage uses the stronger, more active expression.

Important distinction: **carve out a niche vs dominate a market**

carve out a niche

= establish a small/specialized distinct position.

dominate a market

= control a large share or strongly outperform competitors.

A niche business can succeed without dominating the whole market.

Important distinction: **carve out a niche vs stand out**

stand out

= be noticeably different.

carve out a niche

= turn that difference into a stable specialized position.

So:

> custom cakes help the bakery **stand out**

> and over time help it

> **carve out a niche**.

Important distinction: ****carving — object vs activity****

Object:

> “a wooden carving”

= 一件木雕

Activity:

> “wood carving”

= 木雕這門技藝 / 活動

Same noun form, different countability/function.

Important distinction: ****carved vs engraved****

****carved sign****

may involve deeply shaped/raised design.

****engraved sign****

usually has letters/designs incised into surface.

Not always interchangeable.

Important note on source phrasal verb

Normally we exclude phrasal verbs unless essential. Here ****carve out**** is essential because the source sentence is:

> ****carve out a niche****

If we only curated bare ****carve****, we would miss the exact passage meaning.

So this should stay in the entry as a ****source-essential figurative extension****, not as random phrasal-verb expansion.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **carve — material** = 雕刻 / 雕成
* **carve — inscription/design** = 刻上
* **carve — meat** = 切肉 / 切片分食
* **carving — artwork** = 雕刻品
* **carving — activity** = 雕刻技藝
* **carver** = 雕刻師
* **carve out — literal** = 鑿出 / 挖出
* **carve out — figurative** = 開創 / 建立
* **carve out a niche** = 開拓利基 / 建立獨特定位
* **carve out time** = 擠出 / 騰出時間
* **carve out a role/identity** = 建立角色 / 塑造定位
* **carve a path** = 開闢 / 闖出一條路
* **carved** = 雕刻的 / 有刻紋的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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carve — material	用刀具切削木頭、石頭等，使其形成形狀或圖案
carve — inscription	在表面切出文字、圖案或記號
carve — food	把整塊熟肉 / 家禽切成可食用的片或份量
carving — object	經雕刻製成的物件 / 藝術作品
carving — activity	雕刻這項工藝或技術
carve out — literal	透過切削、侵蝕或挖掘形成空間 / 形狀
carve out — figurative	經努力在競爭環境中逐步建立位置、事業或領域
carve out a niche	靠專門化 / 差異化建立獨特市場定位
carve out time	從繁忙安排中刻意騰出時間
carve out a role/identity	為自己逐步建立角色、身份或定位
carve a path	開闢道路；比喻開創自己的方向
carved	經雕刻加工或帶有刻紋的

For your original sentence

> “...they also make custom birthday cakes, which has helped them **carve out a niche** in the local area.”

The exact meaning is:

****carve out a niche = Golden Crust 靠訂製生日蛋糕這種較具特色的服務，在本地市場中逐步建立出一個與其他普通麵包店不同的專門定位。****

Natural translation:

> ****「除此之外，他們也會做訂製生日蛋糕，而這幫助他們在區內建立了自己的特色市場定位。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****carve wood**** → 雕刻木頭
- > ****carve a name**** → 刻上名字
- > ****carve a turkey**** → 切火雞
- > ****a carving**** → 雕刻品
- > ****carve out a niche**** → 開拓利基 / 建立獨特定位
- > ****carve out time**** → 擠出時間
- > ****carve a path**** → 闖出一條路
- > ****carve vs cut**** → 有目的雕刻 / 切分 vs 一般切割